

RICHARD NIXON
(1969-1974)

✪ Apolo 11 mission puts the first man on the moon

✪ China visit (1972) starts new era of Sino-US ties; Watergate scandal

High: Waives interest on $3 bn worth of payments for food

Low: Supports Pakistan in 1971 war, orders sixth fleet into Bay of Bengal



GERALD FORD
(1974-1977)

✪ Fall of Saigon marks end of US involvement in Vietnam (1975)

High: Indo-US joint commission set up for "more productive long-term relationship"

Low: Criticises Indira Gandhi's Emergency; puts off visit to India

JIMMY CARTER
(1977-1981)

✪ US initiates peace treaty between Egypt and Israel (1978)

✪ US hostage crisis in Tehran ('79)

High: Visits India in 1978, village in Gurgaon named Carterpuri; US-India trade booms

Low: US ire over India not condemning Soviet invasion of Afghanistan; PM Morarji Desai rebuffs offer to sign Non-Proliferation Treaty; India denied enriched uranium





RONALD REAGAN
(1981-1989)

✪ Strategic Defense Initiative anti-missile shield (1983); Iran-Contra affair

High: Agrees to give India jet engines, supercomputers; supports Indian intervention in Sri Lanka; state visits to US by Indira and Rajiv Gandhi

Low: $2.5 billion arms package for Pakistan



GEORGE H.W. BUSH
(1989-1993)

✪ End of Cold War with collapse of Communist regimes

✪ First Gulf War (1991) ends in defeat of Iraq

High: Supports IMF loan to India to meet domestic financial crisis (1991)

Low: Refuelling of US military planes in Mumbai during Gulf War sparks furore



BILL CLINTON
(1993-2001)

✪ Oslo Accord with US help allows Palestinian self-government in West Bank, Gaza

High: State visit to India (2000) marks shift in US policy, as it acknowledges India's economic potential

Low: Sanctions India after Pokhran nuclear test; resumes aid to Pakistan



GEORGE W. BUSH
(2001-2009)

✪ 9/11 attacks spark US war on terror; Taliban ousted

✪ War with Iraq, fall of Saddam regime

High: Indo-US nuclear deal brings India out of global nuclear isolation; moves to recognise India as close ally

Low: Pakistan gets non-NATO ally status



BARACK OBAMA
(2009-2017)

✪ Osama bin Laden killed (2011); end of Iraq War

High: Elevation of India as a major defence partner; underscores India's role in stability of Asia-Pacific

Low: Failure to get India into NSG

DONALD TRUMP
(2017-2021)

✪ US pulls out of Paris Climate Accord

High: US-India Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership; US support for India during border row with China

Low: India taken off Generalised System of Preferences which allowed exporters tariff-free access to US market





JOE BIDEN
(2021-2024)

✪ Withdrawal from Afghanistan; tension with China over trade, espionage, Taiwan

High: PM Modi's 2023 visit to US results in slew of agreements in space, 5G-6G and semiconductors; GE F414 jet engines, strategic intelligence and much more

Low: US allegation of India's hand in plot to kill Khalistani separatist Gurpatwant Singh Pannun is a wrinkle in ties

Compiled by Saikat Niyogi